

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Reading and Writing	Expression of Ideas	Transitions	Hard

Question

In astrophysics, a ring of debris orbiting a larger object within the object’s Roche limit is expected to persist as a ring, whereas a ring of debris orbiting outside this limit would likely accrete into a satellite (e.g., a moon). Bruno Morgado and colleagues, _____ detected a dense ring of material orbiting the trans-Neptunian object Quaoar at a distance of 2,500 miles, well outside the calculated Roche limit of 1,100 miles, that has remained intact.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

Answer

- A. though,
- B. for example,
- C. fittingly,
- D. likewise,

Correct Answer: A

Rationale

Choice A is the best answer. “Though” logically signals that the information in this sentence—that Morgado and colleagues detected a dense ring orbiting outside the Roche limit that remained intact—presents an exception to the previous sentence’s claim about debris orbiting outside an object’s Roche limit. Such debris would be expected to accrete into a satellite, not remain intact as a ring.

Choice B is incorrect because “for example” illogically signals that the information about Morgado’s discovery exemplifies the previous sentence’s claim about debris orbiting outside an object’s Roche limit. Instead, the sentence presents an exception to the claim. Choice C is incorrect because “fittingly” illogically signals that the information about Morgado’s discovery aligns with the previous sentence’s claim about debris orbiting outside an object’s Roche limit. Instead, the sentence presents an exception to the claim. Choice D is incorrect because “likewise” illogically signals that the information about Morgado’s discovery is similar to the previous sentence’s claim about debris orbiting outside an object’s Roche limit. Instead, the sentence presents an exception to the claim.